



NEKURATI

UI / UX DESIGN CASE STUDY

Fantasy Game Interface System

BY JAIKAR

FIGMA	PHOTOSHOP	ILLUSTRATION	UI / UX
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A comprehensive UI system built for immersive dark fantasy gameplay—combining clarity, thematic consistency, and intuitive player interaction.

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Project Overview

ROLE

UI Designer · UI Systems Implementation

TOOLS USED

Godot Engine — UI layout, interaction logic, implementation

GDScript — UI behaviour scripting and menu interaction systems

Figma — wireframing, prototyping, and interaction flow

Adobe Photoshop — UI asset creation and visual design

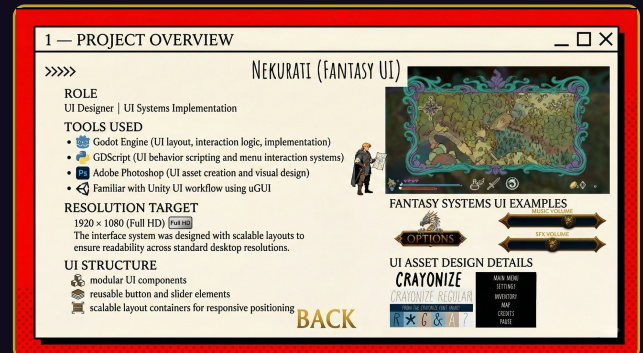
Adobe Illustrator — ornate frame and icon artwork

RESOLUTION TARGET

1920 × 1080 (Full HD) — scalable layouts for readability across standard desktop resolutions.

UI STRUCTURE

- Modular UI components
- Reusable button and slider elements
- Scalable layout containers for responsive positioning



ABOUT THE PROJECT

Nekurati is a fantasy-themed interface design project focused on building a clear and immersive UI system for player navigation, inventory management, map exploration, and gameplay settings. The objective was to create a readable and intuitive interaction system while maintaining the visual atmosphere of a dark fantasy world. The UI emphasizes clarity, minimal visual clutter, and consistent visual language across all gameplay systems.

CLARITY

Players instantly recognize interactions

IMMERSION

UI supports the world without dominating it

CONSISTENCY

Thematic visual language across all systems

NAVIGATION

Responsive, intuitive player wayfinding

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Design Goals



Design Goals Overview — Clarity & Minimal Disruption

CLARITY	Players should instantly recognize available interactions. Every UI element communicates its purpose through visual hierarchy, scale, and colour — no guesswork required.
MINIMAL DISRUPTION	UI overlays must not interrupt gameplay immersion. Menus appear as elegant overlays that feel native to the fantasy world, preserving atmosphere while delivering function.
CONSISTENCY	A unified visual language connects every system — from the main menu to inventory panels and the pause screen. Repeated patterns reduce cognitive load and build trust.
THEMATIC FIDELITY	Every button, slider, and frame draws from the dark fantasy aesthetic. Gold filigree, rune borders, and teal crystal accents reinforce the world-building at the UI level.

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Visual Style



Visual Style Sheet — Dark Fantasy Aesthetic

The interface uses a dark fantasy visual style inspired by atmospheric adventure games. Every design decision reinforces the tone of the world while ensuring UI elements remain legible and accessible to players.

DARK BACKGROUNDS

Deep charcoal and midnight-purple backgrounds reduce visual fatigue during extended sessions and create natural contrast for gold and teal UI elements.

ORNATE ASSET DESIGN

Decorative fantasy frames surround key UI components. Dragon motifs, filigree borders, and runic script echo the game's lore and world-building.

GLOW HIGHLIGHTS

Subtle glow effects on interactive elements communicate affordance — teal glows signal hover states; gold glows confirm selection.

MINIMAL CLUTTER

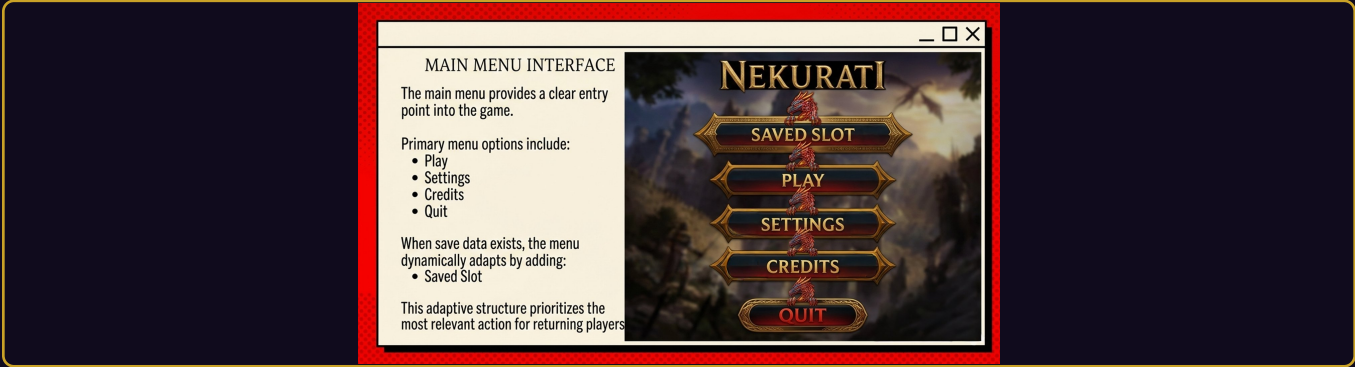
Screen real estate is treated as precious. Only essential information is displayed in-game, with deeper systems accessible via deliberate player action.

COLOUR PALETTE

■ Gold Primary #C9A227	■ Teal Accent #2EC4B6	■ Purple Deep #6B3FA0	■ Cream Text #F0EDE8	■ BG Dark #0D0B14	■ Warning Red #8B1A2A
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Main Menu Interface



Main Menu — Nekurati Fantasy UI

DESIGN RATIONALE

The main menu provides a clear entry point into the game world. It is designed to orient both new and returning players immediately, with visual hierarchy guiding attention from the logo to the primary action.

PRIMARY MENU OPTIONS

- Play — begins or continues the adventure
- Saved Slot — shown dynamically when save data exists
- Settings — audio, display, and control preferences
- Credits — project and team recognition
- Quit — exits the application safely

ADAPTIVE STRUCTURE

When save data exists the Saved Slot option appears above Play, prioritising the most relevant action for returning players without cluttering the interface for first-time players.

KEY DECISIONS

Decision	Reasoning
Dragon motif on buttons	Reinforces world identity
Gold on dark background	Maximum readability contrast
Stacked vertical layout	Clear scannable hierarchy
Hover glow feedback	Communicates interactivity
No animation on idle	Avoids distraction from menu

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Pause Menu System



Pause Menu System — with Exit Confirmation Dialogue

MENU STRUCTURE

- Resume Gameplay — immediately returns to action
- Restart from Checkpoint — resets to last save point
- Settings — preferences overlay
- Return to Main Menu — safe navigation back
- Exit Game — with confirmation dialogue

SAVE STATUS INDICATOR

A persistent Save Status label at the bottom of the panel communicates whether progress will be retained, preventing accidental data loss.

EXIT CONFIRMATION DIALOGUE

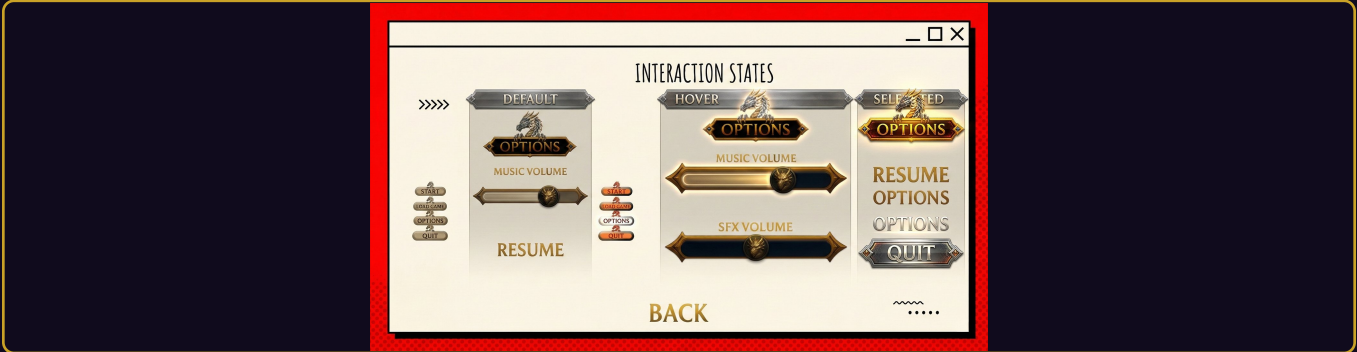
Destructive actions trigger a contextual warning overlay using the Crayonize Regular typeface, warning the player that progress will be lost. YES / NO options are presented inline, maintaining the thematic frame style.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Resume is always the first and most prominent option
- Destructive options (Exit) use warning-red colouring
- Save status is always visible before destructive actions
- Confirmation dialogue prevents accidental progress loss

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Interaction States



Interaction States — Default · Hover · Selected

Every interactive element in the Nekurati interface has three clearly distinct visual states. This feedback system ensures players always understand which element is active, which they are hovering, and what is currently selected.

STATE	VISUAL TREATMENT	PURPOSE
DEFAULT	Muted bronze button, subdued dragon icon, dark fill	Resting state — readable but unobtrusive
HOVER	Brightened gold border, enlarged icon, glow effect, expanded options	Communicates interactivity on approach
SELECTED	Full gold highlight, active dragon crest, high-contrast label	Confirms current selection clearly

SLIDER INTERACTION

Volume sliders (Music / SFX) use the same visual language: a dark track with a golden thumb featuring the dragon crest motif. On hover, the slider brightens and the track receives a teal inner glow to signal active control.

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Inventory System & World Map



Final System Overview (left) · World Map Panel (right)

INVENTORY SYSTEM

The inventory panel uses a tabbed interface — Inventory, Map, Codex — housed within ornate fantasy frames. Items are displayed in a grid with icon-first design, accompanied by item names for accessibility.

- Dragon-Hilt Sword — weapon slot with rarity glow
- Sapphire Amulet — accessory with gem icon
- Potion — consumable with vial illustration

Empty slots are visible but muted, communicating available capacity without drawing attention away from collected items.

WORLD MAP

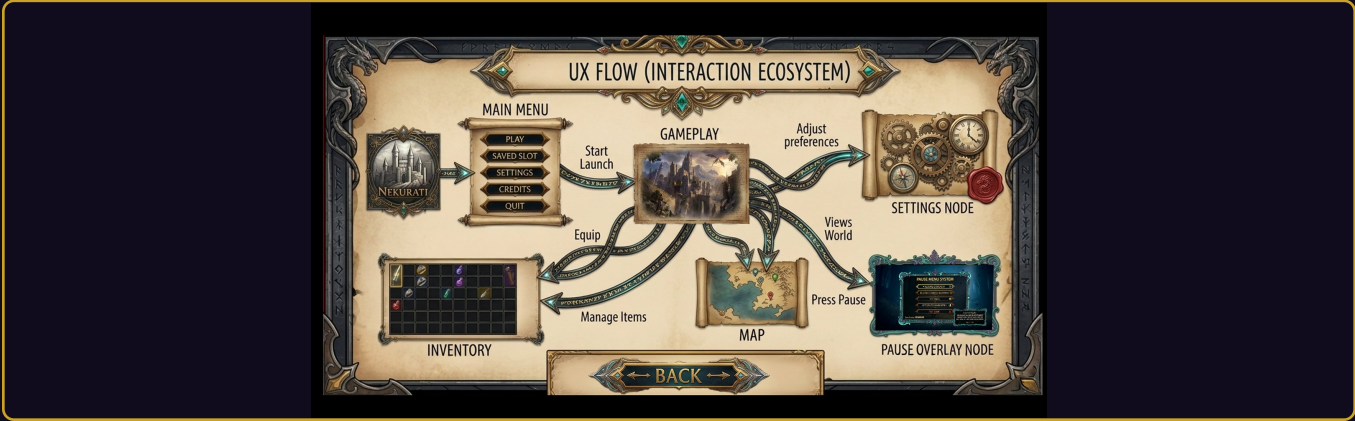
The map panel — Nekurati: Ancient Realms — uses a parchment-textured background with illustrated terrain. Named locations (Silent Peaks, Whispering Woods, Anciented Canyon) are marked with glowing icons that distinguish quest objectives from general landmarks.

NAVIGATION CONTROLS

- Back — exit map panel
- Select — interact with a location
- Zoom In / Out — magnification control
- Track Objective — set active quest marker

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UX Flow — Interaction Ecosystem



UX Flow — Full Interaction Ecosystem Diagram

The interaction ecosystem maps every player pathway through the Nekurati interface. Each node represents a distinct UI state; arrows describe the actions that trigger transitions. The design ensures no dead-ends and always provides a route back to gameplay.

NODE	ENTRY ACTION	EXIT ACTIONS
Main Menu	Game launch	Play → Gameplay Settings → Settings Node Quit
Gameplay	Press Play	Pause → Pause Overlay Map → Map View Inventory
Pause Overlay	Press Pause button	Resume → Gameplay Settings → Settings Node Return → Main Menu
Settings Node	Via Menu or Pause	Back → previous screen
Inventory	Open during Gameplay	Equip → Gameplay Manage Items → Inventory
Map	Open during Gameplay	Views World → Gameplay Track Objective

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Final System Overview



Final System Overview — Nekurati Fantasy UI

SYSTEM ACHIEVEMENTS

CLEAR HIERARCHY Visual priority guides players through every screen	RESPONSIVE NAV All transitions feel immediate and purposeful	THEMATIC UNITY Gold, teal, and ornate frames unify every system	INTUITIVE UX Players understand the interface without tutorials
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TYPOGRAPHY

The Crayonize font family was selected as the primary typeface. Its hand-crafted character sits naturally within the fantasy aesthetic while maintaining strong legibility at title and body sizes. Crayonize Regular handles supporting copy and dialogue text, while the Bold weight anchors headings and button labels.

Crayonize Bold	Used for: Main Menu, Settings, Inventory, Map, Credits, Pause
Crayonize Regular	Used for: Dialogue, descriptions, confirmation text, tooltips

"The UI is designed to support the world rather than dominate the screen."

Nekurati — UI/UX Case Study · By Jaikar

Figma · Adobe Photoshop · Adobe Illustrator · Godot Engine · GDScript